Lopping Shear



Category: **Agriculture & Gardening** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 4 labs

Covers these lab items: Looping shear; Loppers or Pruning Saw; Lopping Shear

What it is used for

To cut or prune branches using lopping shears. To make clean cuts safely while reducing damage to the plant and avoiding tool slippage.

Main parts

- Cutting blade
- Counter blade or anvil
- Long handles
- Grip
- Locking catch

Before you start

1. Select loppers suitable for the branch diameter and type.
2. Inspect blades, handles, pivot, and locking catch for damage.
3. Wear gloves and eye protection where appropriate.
4. Check the work area for overhead hazards and stable footing.

How to use

1. Release the locking catch and open the handles fully.
2. Position the branch near the intended cutting point within the blade's rated capacity.
3. Hold both handles securely and keep fingers away from the blades and pivot.
4. Apply steady pressure until the branch is cut.
5. Avoid twisting the tool or forcing it beyond its capacity.
6. Check the cut and reposition only after the blades are clear.
7. Close and lock the tool after use.

⚠ Safety

- Keep hands and face away from the cutting path.
- Do not cut branches above safe reach or near power lines.
- Never use damaged loppers or exceed their rated capacity.
- Keep the tool locked when carrying or storing it.

Care & storage

- Remove sap and plant residue after use.

- Dry the blades and apply suitable rust protection if needed.
- Lubricate the pivot according to the manufacturer's instructions.
- Sharpen or replace blades when required.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Cutting branches thicker than the tool's capacity.
- Twisting the handles during cutting.
- Working from an unstable ladder or unsafe position.
- Leaving the blades unlocked during storage.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.